CHILDREN AND CHILD PROTECTION

FOUR LIMBS → AGE RULES BY STATUTE → TWO TRACKS COMPARED → TRANSFER SEQUENCE → OFFENCE AND PROCEDURE CARD → CONVENTIONS PAIR

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 — FOUR LIMBS

FOUR LIMBS · PROTECTION FROM HARM · SEXUAL-OFFENCES STATUTE 2012; CHILD-MARRIAGE STATUTE 2006 · JUSTICE SYSTEM · JUVENILE-JUSTICE STATUTE 2015; BOARD FOR CONFLICT, COMMITTEE FOR CARE · WELFARE AND CARE · MISSION VATSALYA; INSTITUTIONS, HELPLINE 1098, SPONSORSHIP, FOSTER CARE · CHILD-RIGHTS COMMISSION UNDER THE 2005 ACT; EXAMINE, INQUIRE, RECOMMEND

PROTECTION FROM HARM → sexual-offences statute 2012; child-marriage statute 2006

JUSTICE SYSTEM → juvenile-justice statute 2015; Board for conflict, Committee for care → **WELFARE AND CARE → Mission Vatsalya; institutions, helpline 1098, sponsorship, foster care** → **OVERSIGHT → child-rights commission under the 2005 Act; examine, inquire, recommend, inspect**

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- PROTECTION FROM HARM → sexual-offences statute 2012; child-marriage statute 2006
- JUSTICE SYSTEM → juvenile-justice statute 2015; Board for conflict, Committee for care

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- WELFARE AND CARE → Mission Vatsalya; institutions, helpline 1098, sponsorship, foster care
- OVERSIGHT → child-rights commission under the 2005 Act; examine, inquire, recommend, inspect

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- USE → locate the failure in one limb before proposing any remedy
- PROTECTION FROM HARM → sexual-offences statute 2012; child-marriage statute 2006

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: USE → locate the failure in one limb before proposing any remedy.

01

STAGE 01 — AGE RULES BY STATUTE

AGE RULES BY STATUTE · SEXUAL OFFENCES 2012 · CHILD IS ANY PERSON BELOW 18; THE ACT IS · CHILD LABOUR 2016 · COMPLETE BAN BELOW 14; HAZARDOUS-ONLY BAN FOR AGES 14 · CHILD MARRIAGE 2006 · BOY BELOW 21 AND GIRL BELOW 18 RECORDED AS · JUVENILE JUSTICE 2015

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
SEXUAL OFFENCES 2012 → child is any person below 18; the Act is gender-neutral	CHILD MARRIAGE 2006 → boy below 21 and girl below 18 recorded as the thresholds	TRAP → never carry one statute's age rule into another statute
CHILD LABOUR 2016 → complete ban below 14; hazardous-only ban for ages 14 to 18	JUVENILE JUSTICE 2015 → 16 to 18 band matters only for a heinous offence	SEXUAL OFFENCES 2012 → child is any person below 18; the Act is gender-neutral

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- SEXUAL OFFENCES 2012 → child is any person below 18; the Act is gender-neutral
- CHILD LABOUR 2016 → complete ban below 14; hazardous-only ban for ages 14 to 18

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- CHILD MARRIAGE 2006 → boy below 21 and girl below 18 recorded as the thresholds
- JUVENILE JUSTICE 2015 → 16 to 18 band matters only for a heinous offence

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- TRAP → never carry one statute's age rule into another statute
- SEXUAL OFFENCES 2012 → child is any person below 18; the Act is gender-neutral

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → never carry one statute's age rule into another statute.

02

STAGE 02 — TWO TRACKS COMPARED

TWO TRACKS COMPARED · CONFLICT WITH LAW · JUVENILE JUSTICE BOARD; MAGISTRATE PLUS TWO SOCIAL WORKERS · INQUIRY AND DISPOSAL ON A REHABILITATIVE FOOTING · CARE AND PROTECTION · CHILD WELFARE COMMITTEE; CHAIRPERSON PLUS FOUR MEMBERS · EXERCISES THE POWERS OF A BENCH OF MAGISTRATES; FOSTER · ROUTING A CARE CASE INTO AN ACCUSATION TRACK CHANGES

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
CONFLICT WITH LAW → Juvenile Justice Board; Magistrate plus two social workers	CARE AND PROTECTION → Child Welfare Committee; Chairperson plus four members	ERROR → routing a care case into an accusation track changes the whole outcome
PURPOSE → inquiry and disposal on a rehabilitative footing	POWER → exercises the powers of a Bench of Magistrates; foster care, sponsorship, adoption	CONFLICT WITH LAW → Juvenile Justice Board; Magistrate plus two social workers

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- CONFLICT WITH LAW → Juvenile Justice Board; Magistrate plus two social workers
- PURPOSE → inquiry and disposal on a rehabilitative footing

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- CARE AND PROTECTION → Child Welfare Committee; Chairperson plus four members
- POWER → exercises the powers of a Bench of Magistrates; foster care, sponsorship, adoption

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- ERROR → routing a care case into an accusation track changes the whole outcome
- CONFLICT WITH LAW → Juvenile Justice Board; Magistrate plus two social workers

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ERROR → routing a care case into an accusation track changes the whole outcome.

03

STAGE 03 — TRANSFER SEQUENCE

TRANSFER SEQUENCE · STEP 1 · OFFENCE ALLEGED AGAINST A CHILD AGED 16 TO 18 · STEP 2 · IS THE MINIMUM PUNISHMENT SEVEN YEARS OR MORE, MAKING · STEP 3 · BOARD CONDUCTS THE SECTION 15 PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT OF CAPACITY · STEP 4

STEP 1 — offence alleged against a child aged 16 to 18 → **STEP 2: is the minimum punishment seven years or more, making it a heinous offence** → **STEP 3: Board conducts the Section 15 preliminary assessment of capacity and circumstances** → **STEP 4: only then may transfer under Section 18(3) follow to the Children's Court** → **LIMIT → adult treatment is exceptional and never automatic**

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- STEP 1 → offence alleged against a child aged 16 to 18
- STEP 2: is the minimum punishment seven years or more, making it a heinous offence

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- STEP 3: Board conducts the Section 15 preliminary assessment of capacity and circumstances
- STEP 4: only then may transfer under Section 18(3) follow to the Children's Court

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- LIMIT → adult treatment is exceptional and never automatic
- STEP 1 → offence alleged against a child aged 16 to 18

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → adult treatment is exceptional and never automatic.

04

STAGE 04 — OFFENCE AND PROCEDURE CARD

OFFENCE AND PROCEDURE CARD · GRADED OFFENCES · PENETRATIVE ASSAULT, AGGRAVATED PENETRATIVE ASSAULT, SEXUAL HARASSMENT · USE OF A CHILD FOR PORNOGRAPHY, INCLUDING THROUGH ELECTRONIC · MANDATORY FOR ANY PERSON HAVING KNOWLEDGE OF AN OFFENCE · SPECIAL COURTS; PROCEEDINGS IN CAMERA · INTERPRETER, SPECIAL EDUCATOR OR SUPPORT PERSON FOR THE CHILD

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
GRADED OFFENCES → penetrative assault, aggravated penetrative assault, sexual harassment	REPORTING → mandatory for any person having knowledge of an offence	SUPPORT → interpreter, special educator or support person for the child
ALSO → use of a child for pornography, including through electronic means	FORUM → Special Courts; proceedings in camera	GRADED OFFENCES → penetrative assault, aggravated penetrative assault, sexual harassment

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- GRADED OFFENCES → penetrative assault, aggravated penetrative assault, sexual harassment
- ALSO → use of a child for pornography, including through electronic means

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- REPORTING → mandatory for any person having knowledge of an offence
- FORUM → Special Courts; proceedings in camera

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- SUPPORT → interpreter, special educator or support person for the child
- GRADED OFFENCES → penetrative assault, aggravated penetrative assault, sexual harassment

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SUPPORT → interpreter, special educator or support person for the child.

05

STAGE 05 — CONVENTIONS PAIR

CONVENTIONS PAIR · CONVENTION 138 · MINIMUM AGE CONVENTION: A NATIONAL MINIMUM AGE FOR ADMISSION · PROGRESSIVE ABOLITION OF CHILD LABOUR THROUGH AN AGE FLOOR · CONVENTION 182 · WORST FORMS OF CHILD LABOUR CONVENTION · URGENT ELIMINATION OF SLAVERY-LIKE PRACTICE, TRAFFICKING, FORCED RECRUITMENT · COMMERCIAL SEXUAL EXPLOITATION, ILLICIT ACTIVITY, WORK HARMING HEALTH OR

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
CONVENTION 138 → Minimum Age Convention; a national minimum age for admission to work	CONVENTION 182 → Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention	ALSO → commercial sexual exploitation, illicit activity, work harming health or morals
AIM → progressive abolition of child labour through an age floor	AIM → urgent elimination of slavery-like practice, trafficking, forced recruitment	CONVENTION 138 → Minimum Age Convention; a national minimum age for admission to work

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- CONVENTION 138 → Minimum Age Convention; a national minimum age for admission to work
- AIM → progressive abolition of child labour through an age floor

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- CONVENTION 182 → Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention
- AIM → urgent elimination of slavery-like practice, trafficking, forced recruitment

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- ALSO → commercial sexual exploitation, illicit activity, work harming health or morals
- CONVENTION 138 → Minimum Age Convention; a national minimum age for admission to work

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ALSO → commercial sexual exploitation, illicit activity, work harming health or morals.

06

STAGE 06 — MARRIAGE VALIDITY LADDER

MARRIAGE VALIDITY LADDER · GENERAL RULE · A CHILD MARRIAGE IS VOIDABLE AT THE OPTION OF · THE MARRIAGE STANDS IN LAW UNTIL THAT PARTY ELECTS · SPECIFIED SITUATIONS · FORCE, TRAFFICKING OR AN ABDUCTED CHILD MAKE THE MARRIAGE · CHILD MARRIAGE PROHIBITION OFFICERS MAY PREVENT SOLEMNISATION, SEEK INJUNCTION · WRITING VOID WHERE THE STATUTE SAYS VOIDABLE CHANGES THE

GENERAL RULE → a child marriage is voidable at the option of the party who

EFFECT → the marriage stands in law until that party elects to avoid it → **SPECIFIED SITUATIONS → force, trafficking or an abducted child make the marriage void** → **PREVENTION → Child Marriage Prohibition Officers may prevent solemnisation, seek injunction**

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- GENERAL RULE → a child marriage is voidable at the option of the party who was a child
- EFFECT → the marriage stands in law until that party elects to avoid it

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- SPECIFIED SITUATIONS → force, trafficking or an abducted child make the marriage void
- PREVENTION → Child Marriage Prohibition Officers may prevent solemnisation, seek injunction

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TRAP → writing void where the statute says voidable changes the legal consequence
- GENERAL RULE → a child marriage is voidable at the option of the party who was a child

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → writing void where the statute says voidable changes the legal consequence.

07

STAGE 07 — PERSISTENCE AND INSTRUMENTS

PERSISTENCE AND INSTRUMENTS · SCHOOLING LOSS, POVERTY, SAFETY FEARS, PATRIARCHY, WEAK BIRTH REGISTRATION · PROHIBITION ALONE CHANGES VISIBILITY RATHER THAN THE HOUSEHOLD CALCULATION · GIRLS' SCHOOLING, SAFE TRAVEL, HOUSEHOLD ECONOMIC SECURITY, REGISTRATION · THE CALCULATION CHANGES AND THE PRACTICE FALLS RATHER THAN · PUNISHMENT ALONE CAN DRIVE SUCH UNIONS UNDERGROUND

CAUSES → schooling loss, poverty, safety fears, patriarchy, weak birth registration → **PROHIBITION alone changes visibility rather than the household calculation** → **INSTRUMENTS: girls' schooling, safe travel, household economic security, registration** → **RESULT: the calculation changes and the practice falls rather than hides** → **CAUTION → punishment alone can drive such unions underground**

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- CAUSES → schooling loss, poverty, safety fears, patriarchy, weak birth registration
- PROHIBITION alone changes visibility rather than the household calculation

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- INSTRUMENTS: girls' schooling, safe travel, household economic security, registration
- RESULT: the calculation changes and the practice falls rather than hides

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CAUTION → punishment alone can drive such unions underground
- CAUSES → schooling loss, poverty, safety fears, patriarchy, weak birth registration

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: the calculation changes and the practice falls rather than hides.

08

STAGE 08 — WELFARE MISSION CARD

WELFARE MISSION CARD · MISSION VATSALYA · UMBRELLA CHILD-PROTECTION SCHEME, RESTRUCTURED FROM THE EARLIER SCHEME · CHILD CARE INSTITUTIONS ESTABLISHED UNDER THE JUVENILE-JUSTICE STATUTE · CHILD HELPLINE NUMBERED 1098 · FAMILY-BASED CARE · SPONSORSHIP AND FOSTER CARE · IT FUNDS STATUTORY DELIVERY; IT CREATES NO ENTITLEMENT OF

MISSION VATSALYA → umbrella child-protection scheme, restructured from the earlier scheme → **INSTITUTIONS → Child Care Institutions established under the juvenile-justice statute** → **HELPLINE → Child Helpline numbered 1098** → **FAMILY-BASED CARE → sponsorship and foster care** → **BOUNDARY → it funds statutory delivery; it creates no entitlement of its own**

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE / DATE

- MISSION VATSALYA → umbrella child-protection scheme, restructured from the earlier scheme
- INSTITUTIONS → Child Care Institutions established under the juvenile-justice statute

WHAT IT PROVES

- HELPLINE → Child Helpline numbered 1098
- FAMILY-BASED CARE → sponsorship and foster care

CLAIM LIMIT

- BOUNDARY → it funds statutory delivery; it creates no entitlement of its own
- MISSION VATSALYA → umbrella child-protection scheme, restructured from the earlier scheme

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARY → it funds statutory delivery; it creates no entitlement of its own.

09

STAGE 09 — COMMISSION DESIGN

COMMISSION DESIGN · COMMISSIONS FOR PROTECTION OF CHILD RIGHTS ACT, 2005; STATUTORY · CHAIRPERSON AND SIX MEMBERS, OF WHOM AT LEAST TWO · EXAMINE SAFEGUARDS, INQUIRE INTO VIOLATIONS, RECOMMEND, INSPECT, ISSUE ADVISORIES · STATE COMMISSIONS PERFORM THE SAME FUNCTIONS AT STATE LEVEL · RECOMMENDATORY; IT CANNOT MAKE AN ORDER THAT BINDS LIKE

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
STATUTE → Commissions for Protection of Child Rights Act, 2005; statutory, not constitutional	POWERS → examine safeguards, inquire into violations, recommend, inspect, issue advisories	LIMIT → recommendatory; it cannot make an order that binds like a court
COMPOSITION → Chairperson and six Members, of whom at least two are women	PARALLEL → State Commissions perform the same functions at State level	STATUTE → Commissions for Protection of Child Rights Act, 2005; statutory, not constitutional

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- STATUTE → Commissions for Protection of Child Rights Act, 2005; statutory, not constitutional
- COMPOSITION → Chairperson and six Members, of whom at least two are women

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- POWERS → examine safeguards, inquire into violations, recommend, inspect, issue advisories
- PARALLEL → State Commissions perform the same functions at State level

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- LIMIT → recommendatory; it cannot make an order that binds like a court
- STATUTE → Commissions for Protection of Child Rights Act, 2005; statutory, not constitutional

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → recommendatory; it cannot make an order that binds like a court.

10

STAGE 10 — ONLINE HARM AND INSTRUMENT MAP

ONLINE HARM AND INSTRUMENT MAP · ONLINE SEXUAL EXPLOITATION · SEXUAL-OFFENCES STATUTE REACHES ELECTRONIC MEANS · ABUSE MATERIAL · CYBERCRIME REPORTING PORTAL CATEGORY ROUTED TO STATE POLICE CYBER · PLATFORM DUTY · INTERMEDIARY RULES; NOTICE OR ORDER, TAKEDOWN AND COOPERATION DUTIES · SIGNIFICANT INTERMEDIARIES

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
ONLINE SEXUAL EXPLOITATION → sexual-offences statute reaches electronic means	PLATFORM DUTY → intermediary rules; notice or order, takedown and cooperation duties	COMPLAINT ROUTE → the commission's electronic reporting box for child sexual abuse
ABUSE MATERIAL → cybercrime reporting portal category routed to State police cyber cells	SIGNIFICANT INTERMEDIARIES → additional due diligence; not one universal detection duty	ONLINE SEXUAL EXPLOITATION → sexual-offences statute reaches electronic means

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- ONLINE SEXUAL EXPLOITATION → sexual-offences statute reaches electronic means
- ABUSE MATERIAL → cybercrime reporting portal category routed to State police cyber cells

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- PLATFORM DUTY → intermediary rules; notice or order, takedown and cooperation duties
- SIGNIFICANT INTERMEDIARIES → additional due diligence; not one universal detection duty

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- COMPLAINT ROUTE → the commission's electronic reporting box for child sexual abuse
- ONLINE SEXUAL EXPLOITATION → sexual-offences statute reaches electronic means

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPLAINT ROUTE → the commission's electronic reporting box for child sexual abuse.

11

STAGE 11 — STATUS AND BOUNDARY

STATUS AND BOUNDARY · SEXUAL-OFFENCES STATUTE, INTERMEDIARY RULES AND REPORTING PORTALS ARE OPERATIVE · STATUS DATE · AS AT 21 JULY 2026 THE CHILD-DATA DUTIES ARE · SUBSTANTIVE CHILD-DATA DUTIES INCLUDING VERIFIABLE PARENTAL CONSENT FROM 13 · DATED ANCHORS · CHILD MARRIAGE 20.1 PER CENT FROM 23.3; ABOUT 10.1 · REGISTRATION, DISPOSAL AND CONVICTION BASES ARE NOT INTERCHANGEABLE

NOW → sexual-offences statute, intermediary rules and reporting portals are operative → **STATUS DATE → as at 21 July 2026 the child-data duties are not in force** → **SCHEDULED → substantive child-data duties including verifiable parental consent from 13 May 2027** → **DATED ANCHORS → child marriage 20.1 per cent from 23.3; about 10.1 million workers aged** → **DENOMINATORS → registration, disposal and conviction bases are not interchangeable**

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- NOW → sexual-offences statute, intermediary rules and reporting portals are operative
- STATUS DATE → as at 21 July 2026 the child-data duties are not in force

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- SCHEDULED → substantive child-data duties including verifiable parental consent from 13 May 2027
- DATED ANCHORS → child marriage 20.1 per cent from 23.3; about 10.1 million workers aged 5 to 14

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- DENOMINATORS → registration, disposal and conviction bases are not interchangeable
- NOW → sexual-offences statute, intermediary rules and reporting portals are operative

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DENOMINATORS → registration, disposal and conviction bases are not interchangeable.

E

EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · NCPCR (2005 ACT) POWERS · (A) EXAMINE AND REVIEW SAFEGUARDS PROVIDED UNDER ANY · NCPCR COMPOSITION · CHAIRPERSON + SIX MEMBERS, WITH AT LEAST TWO WOMEN · NCPCR LIMITATIONS · ADVISORY/RECOMMENDATORY POWERS ONLY; CANNOT ENFORCE ORDERS · JJ ACT 16-18 TRANSFER PROVISION

OPTIONAL RIGHTS AND CAPABILITY DEPTH	INDICATOR, ROUND AND STATUS LIMIT	COMPARATIVE WELFARE-DESIGN NUANCE
NCPCR (2005 Act) powers: (a) examine and review safeguards provided under any	CAUTION: A case where a child's explicit images are shared on a messaging platform: POCSO	CAUTION: Intermediary liability vs encryption: child-safety detection/response duties may
NCPCR composition: Chairperson + six Members, with at least two women, appointed	CAUTION: A 16-year-old accused of a heinous offence: the JJB must conduct the preliminary	CAUTION: NCPCR capacity: a single national Commission overseeing POCSO, JJ Act, RTE,
CAUTION: NCPCR limitations: advisory/recommendatory powers only; cannot enforce orders	CAUTION: A social-media platform failing to comply with an applicable notice/order/takedown	JJ Act, 2015 permits a JJB, after preliminary assessment of a 16–18-year-old accused
CAUTION: JJ Act 16-18 transfer provision: controversial for diluting the juvenile-justice	CAUTION: Rehabilitation vs deterrence (JJ Act 16-18 provision): a possible transfer after	IT Rules impose intermediary due diligence and takedown/response duties; additional

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels